BLOW HOT, BLOW COLD

Is this the air purifier that will change how you look at home purification?

By **CHUMKI BHARADWAJ**



Delhi's dystopian winters summon Dickensian allegories—cold, damp, smog-shrouded days that seep into even more miserable twilight hours. But summer changes all that; it brings fresher air and sun-drenched days, when it's time to banish heaters and air purifiers to their rightful places in lofts and attics. Unfortunately, this year, while the summer sun has come with its expected quota of heat and dust, dismal AQI levels are still spotlighting the urban malaise. For most cities, especially land-locked ones like Delhi, air purifiers are the post modern, tech-loaded sentries that guard our inner sanctums from the virulent maladies associated with skyrocketing air pollution.



And that's why the Dyson Purifier Hot+Cool (HPO7) is such a marvel of tech and design. Not only does it monitor air quality in real time, but even adjusts its settings automatically for those who prefer the fancies without the fuss. However, if you're one of those control freaks who likes to take charge, there's an entire programme of options that allows you to control everything from the direction of the airflow, swing motion, to the noise, and even the temperature at which it cools (or warms as per seasonal requirements). Yes, it does cool (not enough to make the air-con redundant, but it's a pleasant add-on). Although, in winters, it is much more effective at warming the room, but beware the electricity costs, which are pretty significant. However, when you keep it on 'auto' or night mode (when the quiet setting and dimmed display kick in), it does improve energy efficiency. The device comes armed with a magnetised remote control that can be placed on top of the machine.

Dyson's advanced filter technology means that it's not just the filter that meets HEPA H13 standards, but the entire machine. It claims to capture H1N1 virus and 99.95 per cent of particles, even as small as 0.1 microns, which includes allergens, bacteria, virus, pollen and mould. The filters are built for longevity and significant pollutant load, but are fairly easy to clean. All in all, it is a nifty device and easy to use, but if you, like the writer of this piece, require a personalised engagement to understand the functions, the wait could be long. The company prefers to send a DIY video link; I insisted on an engineer visit and had to wait for almost three weeks before one was aligned. Was it worth it? Absolutely. Patience is a virtue as is a brand that understands the need to adapt technology to the lowest common denominator; especially tech-agnostics like me.

PRICE ₹66,900; AT www.dyson.in